concerns. In this section, you'll learn how to organize and group your scenarios to make them easier to understand and maintain.

5.5.1 The scenarios go in a feature file

The role of a scenario is to illustrate a feature, and you place all the scenarios that describe a particular feature in a single file, usually with a name that summarizes the feature (for example, earning_points_from_flights.feature). In JBehave, these files conventionally use the `.story` suffix (`earning_points_from_flights.story`), whereas the Gherkin-based tools use the `.feature` suffix. These files can be read and edited in a simple text editor, though plugins also exist for most modern IDEs. During the rest of the chapter, we'll refer to these files as *feature files*, regardless of the file suffix used.

As you saw in chapter 2, these scenarios are part of the project's source code, and they'll be placed under version control. Many teams write the feature files during the "Three Amigos" sessions (see the "Different types of conversations" sidebar in section 4.5) and store them in the source code repository at the end of the meetings.

The exact file structure used to store the feature files varies from tool to tool. For example, figure 5.6 illustrates a typical Cucumber/Java project, whereas figure 5.7 shows the equivalent story files in a JBehave project.

The `.story` suffix used by JBehave has historical origins and is a little misleading. It's generally a bad idea to have a `.story` file for each user story.[6] Remember, stories are transitory planning artifacts that can be disregarded at the end of an iteration, but features are valuable units of functionality that stakeholders can understand and relate to.

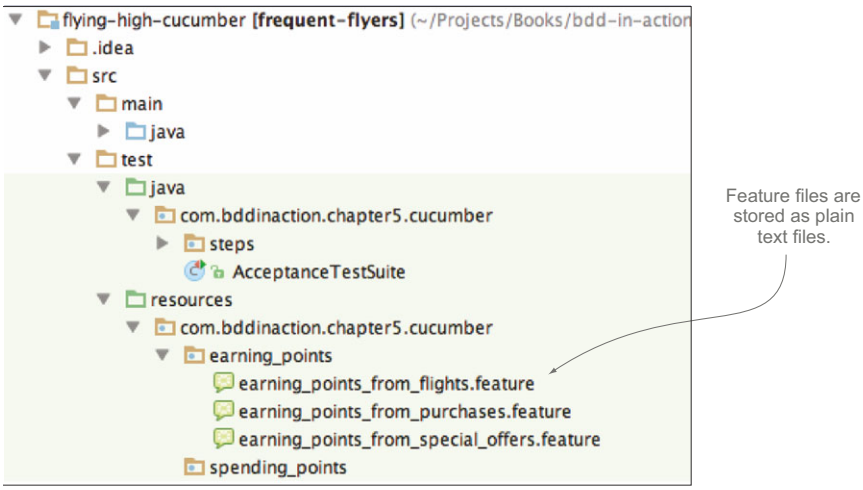


Figure 5.6 Feature files are stored in plain text files as part of the project source code (this example is from a Cucumber project in Java).

[6] There's nothing wrong with using tags or some other metadata to relate a scenario to a story for planning and reporting purposes. You'll see how to use tags as an additional way to organize your requirements in section 5.5.4.